

# September push for military mobility

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## 【要点】

- ・ EU軍事移動規制は9月1日から技術段階に入り、理事会と議会は年末までの政治合意を目指している。
- ・ 軍事輸送許可の期限設定と国家調整官の役割強化について、理事会と議会の意見が対立している。
- ・ 緊急軍事移動対応システムにおいて、加盟国は一括許可か個別対応かの柔軟性を保持したいと主張している。
- ・ 戦略的デュアルユース基盤施設の保護と連帯基金の提案について、さらなる調整が必要である。
- ・ アイルランド大統領国は9月を通じて複数の技術会合と加盟国との二国間協議を予定している。

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## 【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By MARTINA SAPIO with TOMMASO LECCA SNEAK PEEK — The EU's Military Mobility Reg

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By MARTINA SAPIO

with TOMMASO LECCA

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SNEAK PEEK

— The EU's Military Mobility Regulation will enter its technical phase on Sept. 1, with Council and Parliament aiming to keep the file on track for a political agreement by the end of the year.

— Air taxi developers came to Farnborough to convince the industry their aircraft are close to certification, despite years of delays that have cooled enthusiasm for the sector.

— The French government is ready to look into softening the 2035 combustion engine ban, as long as Berlin gets serious about the IAA and backs a more ambitious version of the text.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

SEPTEMBER PUSH FOR MILITARY MOBILITY: After kicking off political negotiations earlier this month, the EU's Military Mobility Regulation will enter its technical phase on Sept. 1, with Council and Parliament aiming to iron out differences and keep the file on track for a political agreement by the end of the year, according to an Irish presidency update seen by Martina.

Battle lines drawn: While the first trilogue on July 16 served mainly to present the institutions' negotiating positions, the presidency says technical negotiators have now been given a broad mandate to tackle both political and drafting issues ahead of future political trilogues.

September packed: The first interinstitutional technical meeting is scheduled for Sept. 1, followed by Military Mobility working party meetings on Sept. 4 and 25. The Irish presidency has also planned bilateral "speed date" sessions with member countries on Sept. 14, 15 and 17 to discuss the file, while asking capitals to prepare their initial reactions to Parliament's negotiating position ahead of the Sept. 4 meeting.

Key transport fights: One of the biggest sticking points according to the presidency update will be military transport permissions, where the Council is defending a five-calendar-day deadline for responding to military transport requests, implementing acts for common forms and a stronger role for national coordinators. Another difficult chapter will be the Emergency Military Mobility Response System, with member countries insisting they should retain flexibility over whether to grant blanket or case-by-case permissions during emergencies.

Negotiators will also need to bridge differences over protecting strategic dual-use infrastructure and the proposed solidarity pool. The Council wants member countries to retain full control over national capabilities and opposes any automatic registration or inclusion of "Union capabilities."

Easier chapters: By contrast, the presidency identifies closer cooperation with NATO, further digitalization and stronger governance through national coordinators and the Military Mobility Transport Group as areas where Parliament and Council are already largely aligned. The Commission, meanwhile, continues to defend its original proposal.

## AVIATION

AIR TAXI DEVELOPERS INSIST THEY'LL REACH THE MARKET SOON: Air taxi developers used the Farnborough International Airshow to renew their promise that their aircraft will soon obtain the certifications needed to carry passengers and, in the long run, reshape air travel. Years of delays have tempered expectations but the nascent industry insists commercial operations are getting closer.

Air taxis are just one example of the many aircraft innovations showcased at Farnborough that are still years away from entering commercial service. Tommaso has more .

Vertical Aerospace flew its prototype in front of thousands of aviation professionals last week. "We baseline the plan to be able to certify it in 2029," said Vertical Chief Engineer David King.

Safety first: "The aircraft is designed to be [at] an airliner safety standard," King said, pointing to the goal of achieving "less than one in a billion odds of a catastrophic failure in a given flight."

Enough demand for everyone: Asked whether competitors could reach certification before Vertical and capture the market, King said industry forecasts suggest demand will comfortably exceed supply. "

Competitors agree: Marc Allen, CEO of hybrid-electric aircraft developer Electra.aero, also believes there will be enough demand for multiple manufacturers. Electra's analysis of journeys in the continental United States that are currently made by car but could one day be served by small aircraft found that the country "needs 12,000 to 16,000 airplanes over the 10 years from 2030 to 2040," Allen said during an event at Farnborough.

Certification remains the hurdle: The biggest challenge for this new generation of aircraft developers remains the lengthy certification process. "The unfortunate thing is that there is no clearly established metrics on how long it takes," said Sergio Cecutta, partner and co-founder of the firm SMG Consulting.

"Every airplane is different from the other ... until we put them up in the air, we don't know how they behave," Cecutta added, noting that regulators such as the U.S. Federal Aviation Administration cannot judge whether a new aircraft is likely to receive certification until they have seen it fly.

## CARS

**THE BIG FRANCO-GERMAN SUMMER BARGAIN:** France believes it has found a strategy to convince Germany to get closer to its position on the Industrial Accelerator Act. The French government is ready to look into further softening the 2035 emissions reduction target for cars as long as Berlin gets serious about the IAA and backs a more ambitious version of the text, French Industry Minister Sébastien Martin told our colleague Giorgio Leali.

**Summer homeworks:** After holding a bilateral summit in a rococo palace near Cologne in mid-July, the bloc's two biggest economies will be negotiating over the summer an overarching deal which would cover all the main files on the EU economic agenda, spanning from the IAA to the auto package and trade defense against China, said Martin. Two German officials also confirmed that negotiation had started.

**Horse-trading:** For years, Germany has been trying (and partially managed to) to water down the ban on the sale of combustion engine vehicles past 2035, which France has so far defended. When it comes to the IAA, France is in favor of an ambitious version which would mainly benefit to EU countries rather than to non-EU trading partners. But Germany has so far been cautious and expressed concerns on the text, fearing to alienate its trade partners.

**Back to school:** Over the summer, two countries will look into ways to please each other, with France backing some kind of extra flexibility to the already watered-down 2035 target and Germany putting its political weight behind a more ambitious version of the IAA. The goal is to agree on a Franco-German position by the fall, just in time for the Sept. 24 meeting of EU industry ministers and for the European Council of October 15-16.

All details in this story by Giorgio and Nette Nostlinger.

**NO VW PLANT CLOSURES (FOR NOW):** Volkswagen played down the prospect of further European plant closures before 2030. "It's not realistic to talk about plant closures up to the end of this decade," CEO Oliver Blume told investors on an earnings call Friday. But he added: "the last option would be to close a plant."

**Defense shift:** Questions remain about what to do with overcapacity in the carmaker's European plants. VW confirmed "advanced negotiations" with the defense industry at their German plant in Osnabrück but did not add any further details due to confidentiality reasons. A decision is expected later this year.

**China pushback:** Blume said the carmaker is considering assembling VW cars developed for the Chinese market at European plants. He ruled out allowing Chinese automakers to use spare capacity at Volkswagen's European factories.

**Employee and earnings numbers down:** 21,000 employees have left the company, "for the most part in the context of early retirement schemes," as officials explained. That number is expected to rise to

about 26,000 by the end of this year, on the way to a target of 50,000 by 2030. Separately, CFO Arno Antlitz said closing Volkswagen's cost gap could require a second wave of up to 50,000 additional workforce reductions worldwide, although he stressed that those measures have not yet been decided. This comes amid dropping revenue: Earnings in the first two quarters of 2026 are down 30 percent compared with 2025.

## MARITIME

**INDIAN SHIPYARDS BREAK INTO EU RECYCLING LIST:** The Commission wants to add the first Indian ship recycling facilities to the EU's approved list, marking a milestone for one of the world's biggest dismantling hubs after years of applications and inspections.

**The shake-up:** The proposal also renews the listing of facilities in Denmark, the Netherlands and Spain, while removing one Norwegian, one French and two Turkish yards. One Turkish facility was struck off after Commission inspectors found repeated safety and environmental shortcomings, including failures to contain oil spills, report incidents and prevent workplace falls.

**What's next:** If adopted, the European List would comprise 39 approved facilities — 28 in the EU, EEA and U.K., eight in Turkey, two in India and one in the United States. The draft is open for feedback until Aug. 30, with formal adoption planned in the fourth quarter of 2026.

## PIT STOPS

Center-right politician Steffen Bilger will take over as Germany's transport minister after his predecessor, Patrick Schnieder, asked Chancellor Friedrich Merz to relieve him of his duties, Tagesschau reports. Schnieder's request came after Merz had announced a Cabinet reshuffle on Friday, but reportedly did not inform Schnieder he was going to be replaced.

## Headlines

Here's a recap of yesterday's news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Romania blames Russia as military shoots down third drone

Sunday's incident marks the third drone shot down over Romania in as many days, in a further escalation for the NATO member.

By Camille Gijs · Jul 26, 2026, 01:32 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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